In May 2016, Subramanian Swamy, MP from the ruling BJP, mounted a very public campaign against the RBI Governor, Raghuram G. Rajan.

On 12 May,[10] he attacked Rajan for the alleged failure of his policies, stating that, in his opinion, 'the RBI Governor is not appropriate for the country… The sooner he is sent back to Chicago, the better it would be.' Intensifying his campaign on 16 May,[11] he wrote to the Prime Minister urging him to 'terminate' his services 'effective immediately' or when his term ends in September because he was 'mentally not fully Indian'. In this letter, Swamy said he was 'shocked at the wilful and apparently deliberate attempt by Dr Rajan to wreck the Indian economy.'

On 26 May,[12] he followed this up with a widely publicized 'open' letter[13] to the Prime Minister in which he levelled six allegations against Rajan, including those of 'sending confidential and sensitive financial information around the world', and being 'publicly disparaging of the BJP government', which, in his considered opinion, required 'terminating his services as RBI Governor immediately'.

Such a public attack on the RBI Governor by an MP of a ruling party was unprecedented. While media speculated on its causes, there was no defence of Raghuram G. Rajan from any government official, nor any response to Swamy's 'open' letter.[14]

On 18 June 2016, Rajan, in a letter notable for its dignity and restraint that was addressed to all RBI employees, stated that he would return to Chicago, after completion of his three-year term as the Governor of RBI, to continue his academic career.

> I am an academic and I have always made it clear that my ultimate home is in the realm of ideas. The approaching end of my three-year term, and of my leave at the University of Chicago, was, therefore, a good time to reflect on how much we had accomplished… On due reflection, and after consultation with the government, I want to share with you that I will be returning to academia when my term as Governor ends on 4 September 2016. I will, of course, always be available to serve my country when needed.[15]